



SoftBank hits \$93B record

Japanese group announced the largest-ever investment fund at \$93 Billion secured from backers. <http://digit.in/Softbank93>



Magikarp gets solo game

The Pokémon Company released a new game, Magikarp Jump. Yes, the stupid pokémon gets its own game. <http://digit.in/magikarpG>

THE DIGIT COMMUNITY IS FILLED WITH BRIGHT IDEAS and we find the best among the best every month to bring them to you in this section.

CHROME OS: Microsoft's dream OS



From survival on Windows to the quest for the perfection in Google's ChromeOS

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o, I was running Windows 8 since it was available as a Technical Preview. I had seen a video or two on YouTube about Metro apps and I mistakenly believed that it was merely a program suite, like

Windows Media Centre. Little did I know that Metro was purported to be the entire OS. It took me few days to get used to the quirky ways of Windows 8. I used Mail instead of Thunderbird, I used that grossly unfinished Music and Video app instead of Windows Media Player and VLC (I had to return to VLC time and again since Video couldn't run most formats). I tried Metro apps on my new touch laptop, when their web/desktop counterparts were way more mature. But, love has its limits. I gave up.

Microsoft like a forsaken lover promised that it has changed. Windows 10 was released. I decided to give her a last chance. Things indeed got better: return of start menu, more consistent design, new browser, UWP apps, Tablet Mode, development based on consumer feedback, few significantly mature apps from Microsoft and other similar stuff. Yet, PC sales continue to decline, and even after forced upgrades and dozen other marketing tricks, Windows 10 is not the success Microsoft claimed. So, what went wrong?

For years, Microsoft had a dominant position in the desktop OS market. The threat to that dominance came from a completely different market of computing devices: smartphones and tablets. In a bid to conquer all worlds, Microsoft came up with Windows 8. And once it turned out to be a disaster, Windows 10 came around. But the journey to where they are right now wasn't easy either. On top of that, the destination isn't exactly perfect.

With the latest Creator's Update, I now have even more apps that I don't really need. And let's be honest, Cortana seldom gets anything done. Windows Ink is useful only if you have a touch-enabled PC. Everything that the Action Centre does was handled quite well by the Notification area in Windows 7. And, live tiles, the innovation that started the whole saga of Metro with Windows Phone 7 – Microsoft

pushed this claim that Tiles were a novel idea since they not only served as a shortcut to the app but also showcased useful information without the user having to open the app itself. Well, widgets have been doing the same thing since Android 1.5. Also, let's compare Android Widgets and Tiles in this regard. Tiles, as of now, either show a picture or some text information; Android, on the other hand, allows the user to interact with the widgets.

The point is that Windows 10 can do a lot of stuff, but most average users don't want to do all that stuff. Windows 10 gives them the Blue Screen of Death so often that it has become completely acceptable and he can't even complain. I decided to dump Windows 10 one fine morning when I had a project due I got stuck at 99% on a Windows update for hours. An Operating System is supposed to assist me, not the other way round.

As far as simplicity is concerned, no one can match Google's Chrome OS. Our favourite Chrome Browser and that is it. The equation further changes with the support for Android apps being brought to ChromeOS. That's exactly what Microsoft wanted to do with Windows – to bring modern, touch-friendly apps to the desktop. But Microsoft has changed its strategy regarding mobile apps since the



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